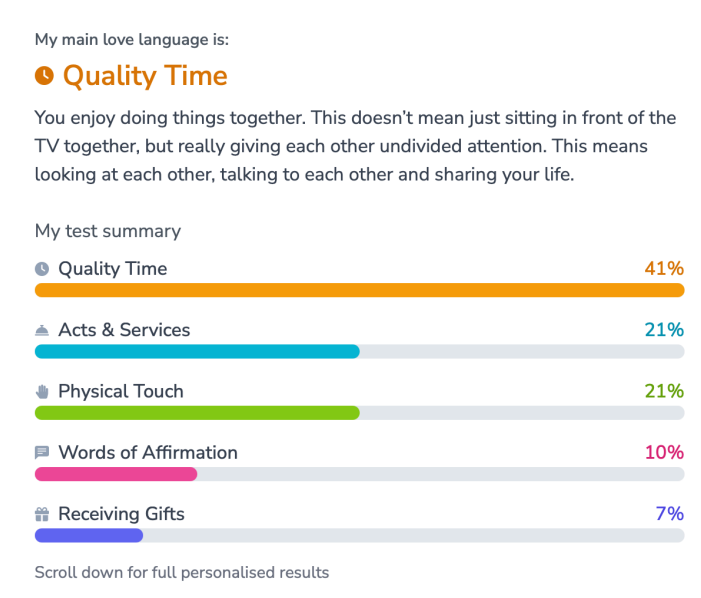


Love and Attachments

My interview subject is going to be my mother. She is 47 years old and I am 20 so that makes our age gap to be over 20 years difference. I am going to interview her in our dining room in our house. I am planning on interviewing her a week before my submission date. I believe on February 26th.

I made my partner take the love language test. His name is Mahdiyar and he is 22 years old. Here are his results:



Reading Haidt's 6th chapter made me realize how much love and wellbeing depends on connection, and not just on personal strength or independence. That opening reminder that "No man, woman, or child is an island" made me see love as something people truly need, not just an optional bonus. I learned to see attachment as something that supports stability and growth, not something that makes people weak. It matters because it changes how I understand my own reactions and how I read other people's behavior.

One of the clearest lessons was that closeness is not a childish preference that people should outgrow. Haidt mentions that "contact comfort is a basic need that young mammals have for physical contact with their mother," and that helped me realize that being distant or cold is not automatically the same as being strong, even if it can look like independence from the top. It also changes how I think about the times I want reassurance, because needing connection doesn't mean I am incapable of anything.

The Attachment Theory Today reading made it more clear to me by showing how early patterns can turn into the kind of relationship blueprint that I can carry on later. It says that "the infant mother bond becomes the blueprint from which future relationship patterns are born". That really goes with Haidt's point that attachment shapes how people look for safety and closeness

throughout their life. What I learned is that when someone comes off needy or emotionally distant, it might be about what they learned to expect from people. For example, whether others feel safe and dependable or not. This behavior of them is not just their personality or their attitude.

I also learned to separate intense attraction from the kind of bond that actually lasts. Haidt mentions that “Passionate love is the love you fall into” and he also says that “Passionate love does not turn into companionate love”. That made me realize how easy it is to mistake intensity for real long term compatibility. It also pushed me to value trust and steadiness, instead of treating emotional highs as a proof that a relationship is strong.

The neuroscience of love article helped me see why early love can feel all consuming and why it can lead people to make impulsive choices. It explains that there are “two main ones are an increase in cortisol and an increase in dopamine” involved in the reward circuit response. That fits with Haidt’s description of passionate love as intense and powerful, especially early on. What I learned is that the rush can be real and meaningful while still being a state that needs guidance, not automatic trust.

Because of these readings, I want to make two big changes in how I show up in my relationships. Firstly, I want to handle closeness needs in a calmer, more steady way, because both Haidt and the Attachment Theory article show that security comes from having reliable care and a secure base. Secondly, I want to be more calm when my emotions spike, since the neuroscience reading explains how stress and reward systems can intensify focus and behavior in early love. Instead of assuming someone’s reaction is irrational or too much, I want to ask what need for safety or reassurance might be under this reaction.

Overall, I learned that love isn't just a feeling. In fact it is a set of systems that shape how people seek comfort, security, and connection over time. The Attachment theory article helped me understand how those systems can be carried forward from early life, and how patterns can be changed through awareness and healthier relational habits. The neuroscience resource helped me see the power of early romantic intensity without treating it as the whole story of love. What I will try to do differently is build more steadiness, interpret my reactions more generously, and value companionate love as a real achievement instead of a lack of passion.

Word count:

746

Sources Used:

Source #1: Haidt, Jonathan. The Happiness Hypothesis, Chapter 6 “Love and Attachments”

Source #2: Attachment Theory Today

Source #3: Georgetown University. The neuroscience of Love What's Going on in the Lovestruck Brain.